To revisit my RV story, these exercises were the very things that helped me find contentment and satisfaction in my season. While simplifying felt somewhat forced on me due to space limitations, refraining from spending my weekends at the thrift stores showed me I actually had other interests. I went on more hikes with friends, dabbled in blogging (that one didn't pan out!), and refurbished furniture to sell. When I chose to focus on "benefits received," I realized that I was truly enjoying the lifestyle. I learned to buy quality over quantity and was grateful for my two amazing knives, four dishes, minimal pantry setup (that was actually inspiring me to cook *more)*, and a small home we owned outright. I also noticed a positive impact not just on my money but the way I felt about how I managed money. I didn't expect it going into the situation, but gratitude led to contentment, which led to better spending habits and more mindful purchases. It cultivated a way of living and thinking that I still carry with me today despite the 1,500 square feet I live in now.

Now, I don't think you need to go live in a vehicle to learn about what's most important, find contentment, and spend on what you value. That was just my journey. In your own way, seek to find contentment without complacency through a mindset of both gratitude and growth. One that finds satisfaction in the present season but also holds on to and pursues opportunity for more as it aligns with your values. It will require an ongoing process of identifying your "enough" and tethering what that means to your finances. Let's take a look at what we're talking about, specifically as it relates to earning more, paying off debt, and investing.

Beyond Spending

As you practice values-based spending, with your money and your time, we believe a natural by-product will be having more of both. And an important part of not going broke is knowing what to do with it. We've mentioned throughout the book that spending is only one part of the equation. We wrote this book because we don't think spending gets enough credit for the significance it has in making every other part of the equation easier. But even with that significance, the other parts of the equation can't be ignored. Your income, debt, and investments are equally important. With every